DRAG LINK AND TIE ROD END INSPECTION AND REPLACEMENT

AFFECTED VEHICLES: CERTAIN 2000 MODEL YEAR F-650/F-750 AND F-7000/F-8000

OVERVIEW

Certain F-650/F-750 and F-7000/F-8000 vehicles will require inspection of the drag link date code. Only drag links stamped with the date codes 9G2 or 9G3 will be replaced. Also, a small number of vehicles may have been serviced with suspect tie rod ends. The VIN numbers of these vehicles are included in this procedure. If you service one of these vehicles, it will be necessary to inspect the date code on both tie rod ends. Please note that if either tie rod end fails inspection, they must always be replaced in pairs.

DRAG LINK DATE CODE INSPECTION

1. **NOTE:** It may be necessary to clean the end cover of the drag link end to read the stamped date code.

   Locate the date code stamped on the end cover of the drag link or on the shaft of the drag link (next to the word “AXLE”). See Figure 1.

   - If the date code is 9G2 or 9G3, replace the drag link.
   - If the date code is not 9G2 or 9G3, no drag link replacement is required.

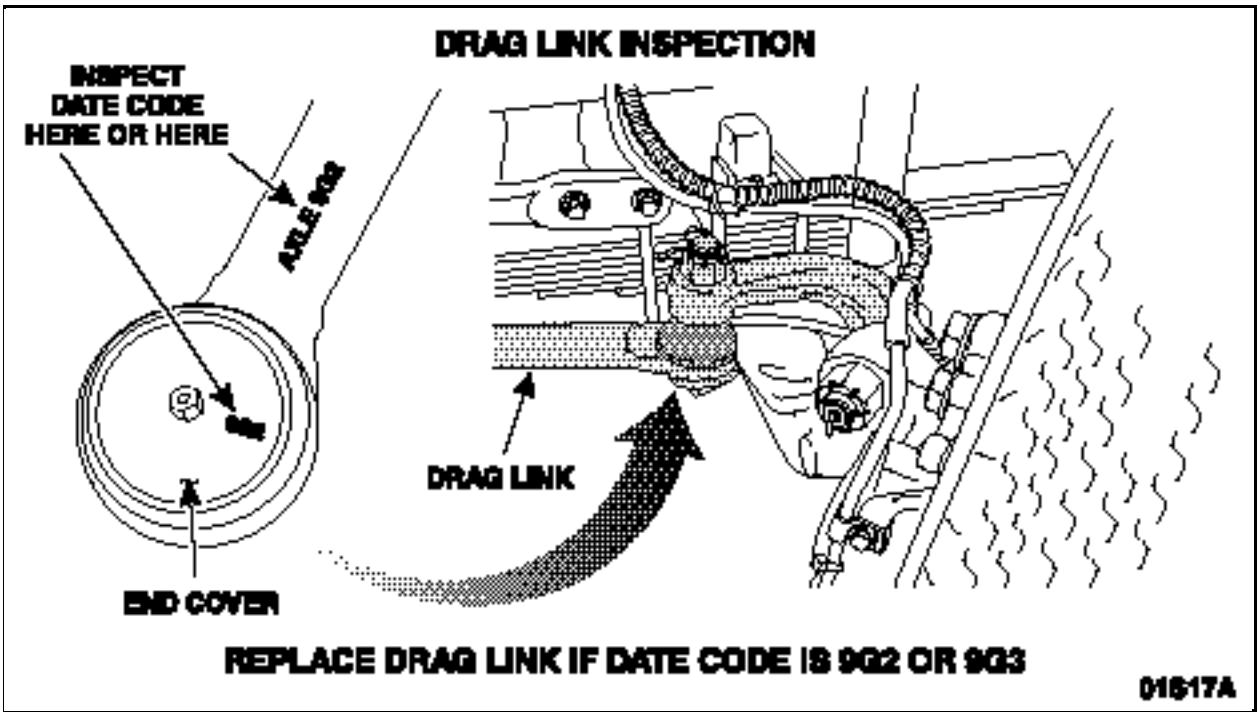

FIGURE 1

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DRAG LINK REPLACEMENT

NOTE: REPLACE DRAG LINK ONLY IF IT HAS FAILED THE INSPECTION.

1. Raise and support the front of the vehicle.
2. Remove the left front wheel and tire.
3. Remove and discard the cotter pin, then remove the castle nut from both ends of the drag link.
4. Separate the drag link from the sector shaft arm and the steering arm, using Steering Arm Remover (T64P-3590-F) or equivalent. Remove and discard the drag link. See Figure 2.

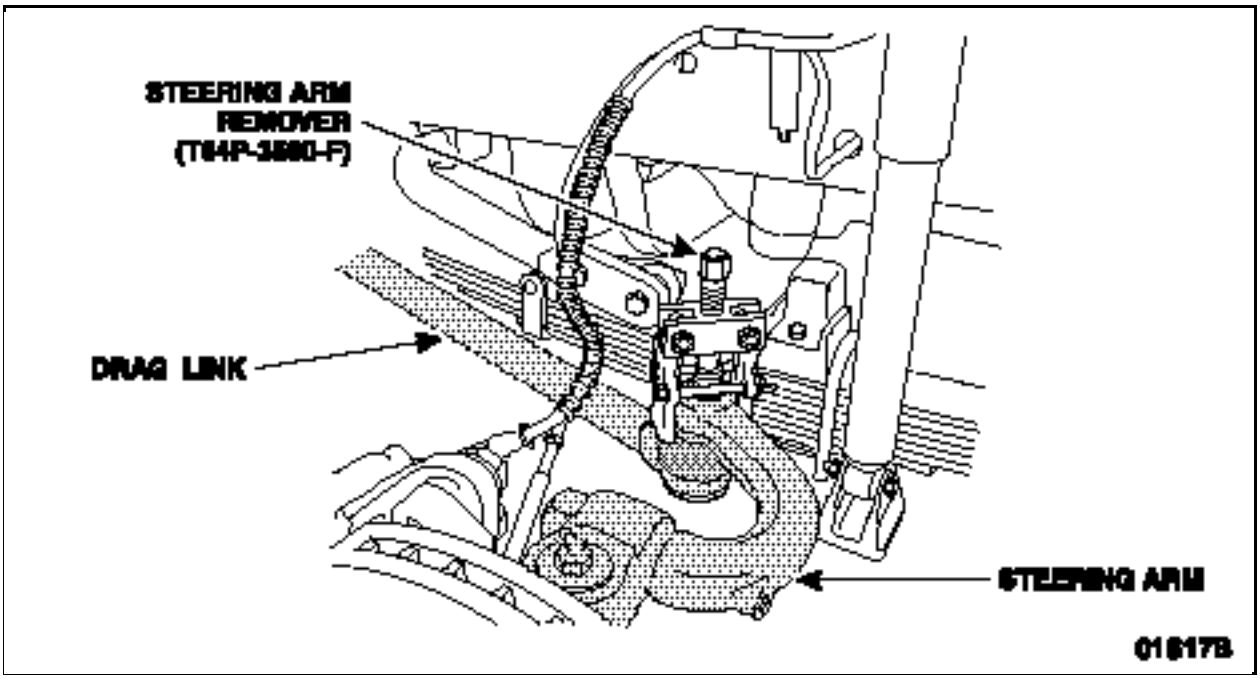

FIGURE 2

5. Position the new drag link onto the sector shaft arm and steering arm, then install the castle nuts. Tighten the castle nut at the sector shaft arm to 115 Nm (85 lb-ft), and the castle nut at the steering arm to 175 Nm (129 lb-ft).
6. Install new cotter pins.
7. Install the left front wheel and tire.
8. Lower the vehicle.

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TIE ROD END DATE CODE INSPECTION

A small number of vehicles may have been serviced with suspect tie rod ends (See VIN number list known to Ford below). Your records may identify additional vehicles which may have received a suspect tie rod end. Review your information to see if you serviced any of these vehicles. Only these nine (9) vehicles and those vehicles identified in your service records will require the tie rod end date code inspection. If you service one of these vehicles, follow this inspection procedure. If either tie rod end is stamped with the date code 9G2 or 9G3, replace both tie rod ends.

Follow inspection and replacement procedure for drag link in Attachment III.

INSPECT THE FOLLOWING VEHICLES	
3FENF80C9XMA13891	**1FDAF56F4XEE71833**
3FEXX75N0YMA00118	3FDXF75HXYMA07935
3FDXF7545YMA17169	3FDWF65H4YMA10433
3FDPF75AXYMA15147	3FDNF65H4YMA07575
3FDNF6543YMA01814	

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1. **NOTE:** It may be necessary to clean the end covers of the tie rod ends to read the stamped date code.

   Locate the date codes stamped on the end covers of the tie rod ends. See Figure 3.

   - If either tie rod end date code is 9G2 or 9G3, replace both tie rod ends.
   - If neither tie rod end date code is 9G2 or 9G3, tie rod end replacement is not required.

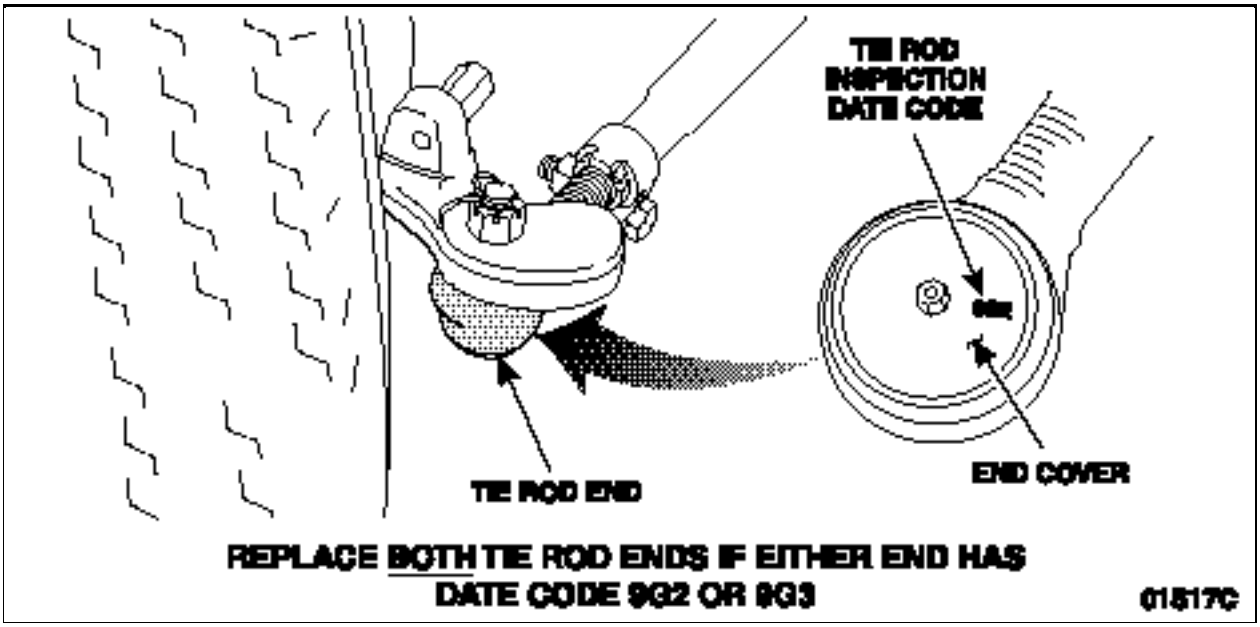

FIGURE 3

TIE ROD END REPLACEMENT

NOTE: IF EITHER TIE ROD END FAILS INSPECTION ON ANY OF THE VEHICLES INSPECTED ON THE PREVIOUS PAGE, PERFORM TIE ROD END REPLACEMENT ON BOTH TIE ROD ENDS.

1. Raise and support the front of the vehicle.
2. Remove the front wheel and tire.
3. Loosen the tie rod-adjusting clamp. See Figure 4.

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4. Remove and discard the cotter pin, then remove the castle nut. See Figure 4.

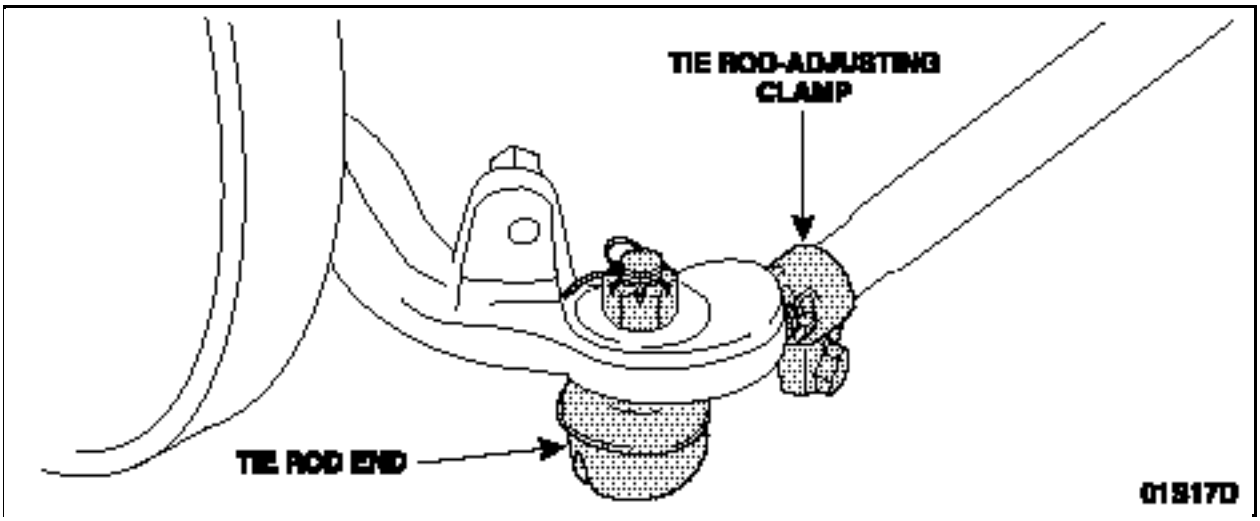
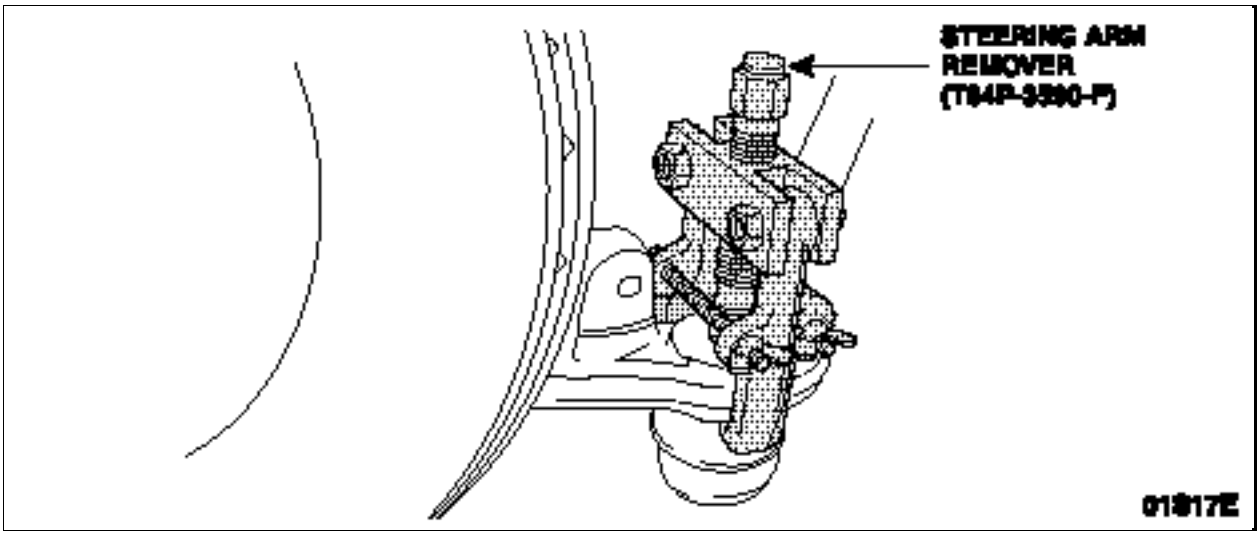


FIGURE 4

5. Separate the tie rod end from the steering knuckle, using Steering Arm Remover (T64P-3590-F) or equivalent. See Figure 5.



6. **NOTE:** Record the number of turns required to remove the tie rod end.

   Remove the tie rod end.

7. Install the new tie rod end into the adjusting tube the same number of turns recorded during removal.

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8. Install the new tie rod end onto the steering knuckle, then install the castle nut. Tighten the castle nut to 133 Nm (98 lb-ft).
9. Install a new cotter pin.
10. Tighten the tie rod adjusting clamp to 80 Nm (59 lb-ft).
11. Perform steps 2 through 10 on the other end of the tie rod assembly.
12. Install the front wheels and tires.
13. Lower the vehicle.
14. Check the toe-in and clear vision and adjust as necessary.

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